system a particular entity or policy belongs. For example, `PhotoApp::User` and `BillingApp::User` represent distinct entity types within separate domains.

- **Policy**—a declarative rule or a set of rules that determines whether access should be granted. Policies describe who can do what under which conditions and serve as the primary means of expressing access logic in modern systems.
- **Role**—a named collection of permissions that represents a function or job responsibility. Examples include descriptors such as `admin`, `editor`, and `billingReviewer`. Roles are generally assigned to principals or groups to simplify management and consolidate related capabilities. If you're confusing roles and groups, keep in mind that all roles can be considered groups, but not all groups are roles.
- **Attribute**—refers to a characteristic of a principal, resource, or environment that informs access decisions. A principal may possess attributes such as department, job title, or clearance level. A resource may be labeled with attributes like owner, classification level, or publication status. Environmental attributes could include location, time of access, or risk score. They are fundamental to context-aware and attribute-based fine-grained access models.
- **Permission**—a specific right to perform an action on a resource. Permissions can be directly assigned, derived from a policy, or bundled into roles. Examples include the ability to edit an invoice, view a dashboard, or delete a customer record.
- **Entitlement**—the effective set of permissions that a principal holds at a specific point in time, determined by roles, attributes, and policies. Entitlements can be calculated dynamically during a request or precomputed for auditing, enforcement, or optimization. Entitlements are not the same as roles. Roles have entitlements associated with them that are inherited by anyone who is assigned that role.
- **Authorization Request**—a structured query to the authorization system that asks: "Is this principal allowed to perform this action on this resource, under these conditions?"
- **Authorization Response**—the result of evaluating an authorization request. It typically returns `allow` or `deny`, and may include metadata